

Firearms Trace Data: Washington - 2023

Data Source: Firearms Tracing System

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

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ATF Firearms Trace Data Disclaimer

Firearm traces are designed to assist law enforcement authorities in conducting investigations by tracking the sale and possession of specific firearms. Law enforcement agencies may request firearms traces for any investigative reason, and those reasons are not necessarily reported to the federal government. Not all firearms used in crime are traced and not all firearms traced are used in crime.

Firearms selected for tracing are not chosen for purposes of determining which types, makes or models of firearms are used for illicit purposes. The firearms selected do not constitute a random sample and should not be considered representative of the larger universe of all firearms used by criminals, or any subset of that universe. Firearms are normally traced to the first retail seller, and sources reported for firearms traced do not necessarily represent the sources or methods by which firearms in general are acquired for use in crime.

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced in Washington in Calendar Year 2023

6,239

Firearm Types with a Washington Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Pistols	3,967
Rifles	1,021
Revolvers	610
Shotguns	527
Receivers/Frames	34
Derringers	32
Machinegun Conversion Devices	25
Other*	23

* Other includes Machineguns, Silencers, Combinations, Unknown Types, Destructive Devices and a Tear Gas Launcher.

Top Calibers Reported on Firearm Traces with a Washington Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

9mm	2,350
.22 Cal	697
12GA	431
.45 Cal	424

.40 Cal	401
.380 Cal	360
.38 Cal	232
.357 Cal	130
5.56mm	125
.223 Cal	111

NOTE: There were 869 additional traces that were associated with other calibers. There were 109 traces with an unknown caliber.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a Washington Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Possession of Weapon	1,027
Found Firearm	957
Firearm Under Investigation	730
Dangerous Drugs	503
Aggravated Assault	404
Family Offense	400
Property Crimes	352
Weapon Offense	321
Simple Assault	264
Suicide	199
Homicide	190

NOTE: There were 892 additional traces that were associated with other categories.

Top 15 Source States for Firearms with a Washington Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Washington	3,430
Oregon	285
Idaho	176
California	131
Montana	90
Texas	82
Arizona	63
Florida	55
Georgia	38
Alaska	37
Virginia	28
Utah	26
Nevada	24
North Carolina	23
Colorado	21

NOTE: An additional 34 states accounted for 322 other traces. The source state was identified in 4,831 total traces.

Time-To-Crime Rates for Firearms with a Washington Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Under 3 Months	247
3 Months to Under 7 Months	222
7 Months to Under 1 Year	261
1 Year to Under 2 Years	576
2 Years to Under 3 Years	571
3 Years and Over	2,944

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 Washington Average Time-to-Crime: **8.85 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Time-to-Crime: **6.76 Years**

Age of Possessors for Firearms with a Washington Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

17 and Under	128
18 to 21	225
22 to 24	264
25 to 30	593
31 to 40	1,233
41 to 50	683
Over 50	626

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 Washington Average Age of Possessor: **38 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Age of Possessor: **35 Years**

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a Washington Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Seattle	942
Spokane	553
Tacoma	526
Vancouver	301
Kent	266
Marysville	249
Renton	200
Kennewick	152
Moses Lake	134
Arlington	119

NOTE: There were 222 additional municipalities that accounted for 2,796 other traces. The recovery city could not be determined for one trace.

Analytical Criteria Used to Compile the Enclosed Statistics

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced

- Includes traces with a recovery state of Washington. Traces in which the recovery state was not provided were included when the requesting agency state was equal to Washington.

- Includes Firearms Recovered and Traced between 1/1/2023 – 12/31/2023 or, if the recovery date was blank, firearms with trace entry dates between 1/1/2023 – 12/31/2023.
- Duplicate traces, Firearms Not Recovered, Gun Buyback and Firearms Turned In are not included in this figure.
- Data was extracted from the Firearms Tracing System (FTS) on April 10, 2024.
- All traces may not have been submitted or completed at the time of this study.

Firearm Types and Calibers with a Washington Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a Washington Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Source States for Firearms with a Washington Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser and the state in which the final dealer is located.

Time-to-Crime Rates for Firearms with a Washington Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser.
- Time-to-Crime was calculated for those traces in which the purchase date could be subtracted from the recovery date.

Age of Possessors for Firearms with a Washington Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces that provide a possessor and the possessor's date of birth.
- Possessor's age is calculated by subtracting the possessor's date of birth from the recovery date.

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a Washington Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces with a recovery city or, if the recovery city was not provided, traces requested by agencies with jurisdiction only within that city.

[View All 2023 Firearms Trace Data](#)

Last updated: December 9, 2024